

January 2026
Curriculum Vitae

Victor R Thompson
Rider University
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Education

Ph.D., Sociology, Stanford University, 2010
M.A., Sociology, Stanford University, 2003
B.A., Sociology, University of Illinois, Urbana–Champaign, 2000
A.A., Liberal Arts, Parkland College, Urbana, IL, 1998

Current Position

Associate Professor of Sociology and Chair of Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice and Social Work, Rider University, Lawrenceville, NJ, *July 2016–present*

Positions Held

Assistant Professor of Justice Studies, San Jose State University, San Jose, CA *August 2016–January 2018.*

Assistant Professor of Sociology; Director, Law and Justice Program, Rider University, Lawrenceville, CA *August 2015–July 2016.*

Founder and Co-Director of Social Science Research and Survey Lab, *2015–2016.*

Assistant Professor of Sociology and Criminal Justice, Rider University, Lawrenceville, CA, *August 2010–August 2016.*

Lecturer, Columbus State Community College, Columbus, OH, *December 2009–July 2010.*

Lecturer, San Jose State University, San Jose, CA, *January 2005–June 2008.*

Research Assistant, Long-Term Health Outcomes Study, 22-Year Follow-Up, Palo Alto VA

Research and Teaching Interests

Race and ethnicity, enumeration practices, crime attitudes, social psychology, social demography, research methods

Administrative and Leadership Experience

Chair, Department of Sociology and Criminology, Rider University

2016–present

- Directed growth of the Criminal Justice program, including strategic faculty hiring to support increased enrollment. Moved from low enrollments to top revenue generating department in university, more than tripling enrollment numbers.
- Facilitate the Council on Social Work Education accreditation process.
- Responsible for leading the department through internal prioritization and alignment with institutional planning.
- Led and coordinated 2 full external program reviews and departmental responses.
- Oversaw curricular changes across Sociology, Criminal Justice and Social Work.
- Managed revenue planning for program.
- Conducted Promotion & Tenure reviews for departmental faculty.
- Coordinate and manage all student related concerns.
- Program director for internships

Bachelor of Social Work (BSW) Program

2023–present

- Directed BSW program development, including curriculum design and sequencing.
- Led CSWE accreditation preparation and assessment mapping prior to arrival of Program Director.
- Coordinated faculty hiring related to accreditation and growth.

Cannabis Studies Certificate

2022–2024

- Organized academic and public-facing events in the emerging New Jersey cannabis industry.
- Collaborated with minority focused academic and community engagement initiatives.

Co-Coordinator, Multicultural Studies (MCS) Program

2015–present

- Regularly advise and organize coursework staffing, development of classes and recruitment efforts.
- Developed the African American Studies and Latinx Studies minors.
- Organized race campus wide events and programming including several events around race and crime during Covid.
- Coordinated experiential and field-based learning opportunities.

- Led the development of African American and Latinx curriculum changes and advising of students.

Campus wide service

2013-present

- Member of Liberal Arts Academic Policy Committee from 2013-2016. Responsible for academic governance at college level (new and current program and course development/changes).
- Core member of General Education Core program development for College of Liberal Arts and Sciences. Developed new model for general education curriculum currently in use, 2014-2016.
- Served on multiple committees related to instructional technologies, hiring of professional staff, academic developments, curriculum development and student services.
- Mentorship through the EOP Program, a New Jersey program providing early start programming and classes for underserved populations through coursework, mentorships, and scholarships/grants.
- Support for interdisciplinary initiatives linking Sociology, Criminology, Social Work, and Multicultural Studies.

Current Works in Progress

Projects/Manuscripts in progress

- Kukutai, Tahu and Victor Thompson. *Global Ethnic Enumeration Practices: Race, Ethnicity, and Culture in the Census, 1965–2024*.

Papers with Students in Progress

- Thompson, Victor and Robert Hode (student). 2026. "Grievance and Violence in Extremist Groups: A Comparative Analysis of Far-Right, Far-Left, and Jihadist Radicalization."
- Thompson, Victor and Janaya Ross (student). 2026. "Meta-analysis of Juvenile Intervention Programs for African American Youth."

Published Articles and Book Chapters

Brogan, M., Rusciano, F. L., Thompson, V., & Walden, K. (2020). *Perceptions of terrorism and counterterrorism: Fear, risk and the 2016 Trump effect*. Journal of Homeland Security and Emergency Management, 17(1), 20180023.

Thompson, V. (2018). "Citizenship and the Census." In R. Fiske-Rusciano (Ed.), *Experiencing Race, Class, and Gender in the U.S.* (7th ed.). Rowman & Littlefield.

- Thompson, V., with T. Kukutai. (2015). "Inside-Out: The politics of ethnically enumerating the nation." In P. Simon, V. Piché & A. Gagnon (Eds.), *Social Statistics and Ethnic Diversity: Cross-National Perspectives*. IMISCOE–Amsterdam University Press.
- Thompson, V., with T. Kukutai & R. McMillan. (2014). "Whither the Census: Continuity and change in census methodologies worldwide, 1985–2014." *Journal of Population Research*.
- Thompson, V., with T. Kukutai. (2014). "Censuses, Population: Comparative International Aspects." In *International Encyclopedia of the Social and Behavioral Sciences*.
- Kukutai, T., McMillan, R., & Thompson, V. (2013). "Census in Flux: Methodologies in global context, 1985–2014." Population Association of New Zealand Conference.
- Thompson, V. (2011). "The Strange Career of Racial Science, Racial Categories and African American Identity." In H. L. Gates Jr. (Ed.), *Handbook of African American Citizenship (1865–Present)*. Oxford University Press.
- Thompson, V. (2011). "Race-Conscious Color Blindness." In H. L. Gates Jr. (Ed.), *Handbook of African American Citizenship (1865–Present)*. Oxford University Press.
- Bobo, L. D. & Thompson, V. (2011). "Thinking about Crime: Race and lay accounts of lawbreaking behavior." *ANNALS of the American Academy of Political and Social Science*, 634(1), 16–38.
- Bobo, L. D. & Thompson, V. (2010). "Racialized Mass Incarceration: Poverty, prejudice, and punishment." In H. Markus & P. Moya (Eds.), *Doing Race: 21 Essays for the 21st Century*. W.W. Norton & Co.
- Bobo, L. D. & Thompson, V. (2006). "Unfair by Design: The War on Drugs, Race, and the legitimacy of the criminal justice system." *Social Research: An International Quarterly*, 73, 445–472.

Book Reviews

- Thompson, V. (2007). "A new take on an old idea: Do we need multiracial studies?" *Du Bois Review*, 3, 437–447.

Reports

- Profiles of American-Indian and Alaskan-Native Children from the 2000 Census. Annie E. Casey Foundation & Population Reference Bureau.

Presentations

- Hode, Robert, and Victor Thompson. 2024. "Group Grievance, Violence and the Far Right." Paper presented at the 79th Annual Meeting of the American Society of Criminology, San Francisco, CA, November 14.

- Ross, Janaya, and Victor Thompson. 2024. "A Meta-Analysis of Family-Based Interventions for Youth and Their Effectiveness for African Americans." Paper presented at the 47th Annual Conference of the Northeastern Association of Criminal Justice Sciences, Gettysburg, PA, June 6.
- Kubik, Joanna, Victor Thompson, Robert Hode, Lizbeth Rodriguez, and Irma Sandoval-Arocho. 2024. "The Impact of Carceral Tutoring on Volunteers' Social Justice Attitudes." Paper presented at the 47th Annual Conference of the Northeastern Association of Criminal Justice Sciences, Gettysburg, PA, June 6.
- Hode, Robert, and Victor Thompson. 2023. "Extremism as a Form of Far-Right Mobilization." Paper presented at the 46th Annual Conference of the Northeastern Association of Criminal Justice Sciences, Williamsport, PA, June 1.
- Kukutai, Tahu, and Victor Thompson. 2023. "The Rise of the Identity State: Ethnicity, Citizenship and the Census." Paper presented at the XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia, June 25–July 1.
- Thompson, Victor. 2015. "How Race Colors Our Love for Guns: Race and Support for Gun Laws." Paper presented at the American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, November 19–22.
- Thompson, Victor. 2014. "Racial and Ethnic Enumeration on the Census in the Americas from 1960–2012." Paper presented at the 84th Annual Meeting of the Eastern Sociological Society, Baltimore, MD, February 20–23.
- Thompson, Victor. 2014. "Racial and Ethnic Enumeration on the Census in the Americas, 1960–2012." Paper presented at the Eastern Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Baltimore, MD.
- Thompson, Victor, Tahu Kukutai, and Rachael McMillan. 2013. "Census in Flux: Global Methodologies, 1985–2014." Paper presented at the Population Association of New Zealand Annual Conference, Wellington, New Zealand.
- Thompson, Victor. 2013. "Mass Incarceration, Friends, and Family: The Racial Unevenness of Exposure." Paper presented at the NIDEA Seminar Series, University of Waikato, Hamilton, New Zealand.
- Thompson, Victor, and Tahu Kukutai. 2013. "Ethnic Classification in the National Census, 1985–2012." Paper presented at the International Population Conference, Busan, South Korea.

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Thompson, Victor. 2012. "Movin' On Up: The Impact of Mass Incarceration on Middle-Class Blacks and Whites." Paper presented at the RAIN Initiative Conference, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.

Thompson, Victor. 2012. "Population Projections of the Mixed-Race Population, 2000–2055." Paper presented at the American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.

Thompson, Victor. 2012. "Friends and Family Behind Bars." Paper presented at the Eastern Sociological Society Annual Meeting, New York, NY.

Thompson, Victor, and Lawrence D. Bobo. 2009. "Thinking About Crime." Paper presented at the American Association for Public Opinion Research Annual Meeting, Hollywood, FL.

Kukutai, Tahu, and Victor Thompson. 2007. "Inside Out: The Politics of Enumerating the Nation." Paper presented at the Social Statistics and Ethnic Diversity Conference, Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Kukutai, Tahu, and Victor Thompson. 2007. "Doing Diversity 'Down Under': New Zealand's Ethnic Enumeration Practices in Global Perspective." Paper presented at the Population Association of New Zealand Annual Conference, Wellington, New Zealand.

Bobo, Lawrence D., and Victor Thompson. 2006. "Prejudice and Punitiveness." Paper presented at the American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Thompson, Victor, and Frank L. Sampson. 2006. "Cybercafes and Cybergames: Virtual and Non-Virtual Spaces for Identity Construction, Social Development, and Interaction." Paper presented at the American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Fellowships and Grants

Fellowships

2006–2007 – Center for Comparative Studies in Race and Ethnicity Graduate Student Fellowship, Stanford University

2005–2006 – Center for Comparative Studies in Race and Ethnicity Graduate Student Fellowship, Stanford University

2000–2001 – Stanford University Graduate Fellowship, Department of Sociology

Grants

2015 – Rider University Supplemental Research Grant (\$3,400)

2015 – Rider University Summer Research Fellowship (\$8,158)

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2013 – Rider University Summer Research Fellowship (\$8,158)

2011–2014 – Co-/Associate PI, Marsden Fund Fast Start Grant (NZ\$300,000 / ~US\$250,000) with Tahu Kukutai, University of Waikato, New Zealand. Project: “Ethnicity Counts? Global Practices of Ethnic Enumeration.”

2006–2007 – Stanford Teaching Assistant Improvement Grant, Sociology Department (\$1,200)

2006 – Travel Grant, African and African American Studies “Paris Noir: Expedition to Paris,” Stanford University (\$1,000)

2005 – Stanford Social Demography Travel Grant (\$1,000)

Teaching Experience

Rider University (2010-current)

- Theories of Racism
- Race and Crime
- Racial and Ethnic Relations
- Research Methods
- Punishment
- Introduction to Law and Society
- Introduction to Criminology
- Crime and Media
- Sociology of Deviance
- Social Demography
- Punishment and Society

San Jose State University, San Jose, CA (2016-2018)

- Race and Crime
- Research Methods
- Introduction to Justice Studies
- Internship Coordinator for Justice Studies
- Research Methods (Graduate level)
- Sociology of Punishment (Graduate level)

Columbus State Community College, Columbus, OH (2009-2010)

- Introductory Sociology
- Sociology of Deviance

San Jose State University, San Jose, CA (2005-2008)

- Social Theory

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Race and Ethnic Relations
Immigration and Identity
Social Problems
Research Methods and Writing for Sociologists
Introduction to Sociology

Stanford University, Stanford, CA (2002-2009)

Comparative Studies in Race and Ethnicity 200X. Senior Seminar—Research Methods and Writing in the Major Comparative Studies in Race and Ethnicity.
Pre-Honors Seminar on Research Methods and Writing a Thesis
Race, Community and Urban Sociology
Honors College Advisor, Bing Honors College
Urban Studies: Building Community, Writing Tutor and Advisor.
Political Sociology, Summer Teaching Fellow
American Language and Culture

Professional Memberships

Population Association of America (since 1999)
American Sociological Association (since 1998)
American Association for Public Opinion Research (since 2002)

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Du Bois Review; The Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics; Sociological Forum; Sociological Quarterly; European Sociological Review; Sage Publications; Oxford University Press.

Software-Proficient or Advanced knowledge

R (Posit), STATA, SPSS, Git /Github, Python, QGIS (Open-source Geographic Information Software), Kaggle